

SENATE No. 535

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Bruce E. Tarr

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to fairly fund early voting.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	
<i>Bradley H. Jones, Jr.</i>	<i>20th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/17/2025</i>
<i>Jason M. Lewis</i>	<i>Fifth Middlesex</i>	<i>1/21/2025</i>
<i>Peter J. Durant</i>	<i>Worcester and Hampshire</i>	<i>3/17/2025</i>

SENATE No. 535

By Mr. Tarr, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 535) of Bruce E. Tarr, Bradley H. Jones, Jr. and Jason M. Lewis for legislation to fairly fund early voting. Election Laws.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 441 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to fairly fund early voting.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 25B of Chapter 54 of the General Laws is hereby amended by
2 inserting at the end thereof the following new subsection:-

3 “(r) The Commonwealth shall reimburse each city and town to the full extent of the
4 amounts expended for mandated early voting procedures and operations. The state treasurer shall
5 annually, on or before July 1st of the year following the election for which reimbursement is
6 being sought, pay to cities and towns, the sums required for such reimbursement and approved
7 by the secretary of state pursuant to section 2 herein. Each city and town may establish an Early
8 Voting Reimbursement Fund. Reimbursements made by the commonwealth pursuant to this
9 section may be deposited into the fund and may carry forward for 1 fiscal year.”

10 SECTION 2. Section 25B of Chapter 54 of the General Laws is hereby amended by
11 inserting in subsection (o) the following at the end thereof:- “including the means to seek,
12 process and approve reimbursement subject to subsection (r)”.